

STATE OF NEW YORK

9586 --A

IN SENATE

March 26, 2026

Introduced by Sens. PARKER, ADDABBO, FERNANDEZ, MARTINEZ -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Transportation -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the public authorities law, in relation to requiring the New York city transit authority to have at least one conductor on board

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. The legislature finds and declares that, the New York city
2 transit authority, through its operation of the New York city subway
3 system, the largest public transit system in the world, provides the
4 primary means of commuting for many millions of New York residents and
5 visitors every day of the week. With an estimated average of over 10,000
6 passengers loaded onto each train during rush hours, the presence of
7 trained New York city transit authority personnel, other than the engi-
8 neer, on each train is necessary and should always be required to ensure
9 improved safety for passengers during emergencies, which may occur while
10 in subway tunnels or traveling over bridges.

11 The legislature further finds and declares that the tragic events of
12 September 11, 2001, which launched the war of terror against America,
13 has tremendously heightened the need to significantly increase security
14 and safety for commuters on New York city subway trains. Also, the
15 recent conviction of Zarein Ahmedzay, who was caught buying explosives
16 and admitted to having planned an attack on the New York city subway
17 system makes it imperative that we recognize the role of conductors and
18 other authority personnel assigned on passenger trains as first respon-
19 ders, and the front line defense to potentially save lives and limit
20 casualties in the event of a terrorist attack.

21 § 2. The public authorities law is amended by adding a new section
22 1205-b to read as follows:

23 § 1205-b. Conductor required. Any subway or train operated by the
24 authority for the purpose of transporting passengers shall have at least
25 one conductor on board, except where it is currently permissible and in

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

LBD07106-04-6

1 effect. For the purposes of this section, the term "conductor" shall
2 mean the person other than the driver, engineer or motorman primarily
3 charged with all aspects of the operation of the railroad locomotive,
4 subway or train, who shall assist in the operation of the train and be
5 primarily responsible for the opening and closing of the doors and other
6 safety aspects of the train.

7 § 3. This act shall take effect immediately.